May 9, 2024

William L. Gamber

Federal Reserve Board
20th and C Streets NW
Washington, DC 20551

Email: will.gamber@frb.gov
www.willgamber.com

Professional Experience

2021–present	Economist, Federal Reserve Board of Governors Division of Research and Statistics Household and Business Spending Section
2016	Summer Associate, Congressional Budget Office Macroeconomic Analysis Division
2013-2015	Research Assistant, Federal Reserve Board of Governors Division of Monetary Affairs Monetary Studies Unit

Education

2021	Ph.D. in Economics, New York University Dissertation: Essays in Firm Dynamics and Macroeconomics
2019	M.Phil. in Economics, New York University
2013	B.A. in Mathematics, *cum laude*, Pomona College

Refereed Publications

1. "The Importance of Entry in the Business Cycle: What Are the Roles of Markups, Adjustment Costs, and Heterogeneity?" (Journal of Political Economy: Macroeconomics, September 2023, Volume 1, Number 3)

   Abstract: In this paper, I evaluate the role of fluctuations in business formation in amplifying business cycles. To do this, I study the response of employment to shocks in a general equilibrium model of producer dynamics with entry and exit. The model features producer heterogeneity, adjustment frictions, and a variable demand elasticity. I find that while heterogeneity reduces the effects of entry on the broader economy, the variable demand elasticity and adjustment frictions amplify these effects, so that entry fluctuations lead to economically meaningful amplification of business cycle shocks.

2. "Stuck at Home: Housing Demand during the COVID-19 Pandemic" with James Graham and Anirudh Yadav (Journal of Housing Economics, March 2023, Vol 59 Part B)

   Abstract: The COVID-19 pandemic induced a significant increase in both the amount of time that households spend at home and the share of expenditures allocated to at-home consumption. These changes coincided with a period of rapidly rising house prices. We interpret these facts as the result of stay-at-home shocks that increase demand for goods consumed at home as well as the homes that those goods are consumed in. We first test the hypothesis empirically using US cross-county panel data and instrumental variables regressions. We find that counties where households spent more time at home experienced faster increases in house prices. We then study various pandemic shocks using a heterogeneous agent model with general equilibrium in housing markets. Stay-at-home shocks explain around half of the increase in model house prices in 2020, with lower mortgage interest rates explaining around one third, and unemployment shocks and fiscal stimulus accounting for the remainder. We find that young households and first-time home buyers account for much of the increase in underlying housing demand during the pandemic, but they are largely crowded out of the housing market by the equilibrium rise in house prices.

Other publications

3. “Winners and losers from recent asset price changes” with Edmund Crawley (FEDS Note, May 2023)”

   Abstract: Asset prices and interest rates have changed dramatically and unexpectedly over the last two years as the Federal Reserve has raised its policy rate to combat higher inflation. In this note, we clarify the redistributive effects of these asset price changes in terms of welfare, which contrast sharply with those of wealth.

Seminar Presentations[1]

2022	Lisbon Macro Workshop*
2021	Federal Reserve Board of Governors, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond, U.S. Census Bureau, Congressional Budget Office, University of Kent Firm Dynamics, Market Structures and Productivity in the Macroeconomy Workshop*
2020	Federal Reserve Board Pre-Job Market Conference
2019	13th NYU Search Theory Workshop

Referee Service

AEJ: Macroeconomics, BE Journal of Macroeconomics, The Economic Journal

Fellowships and Awards

2015-2020	MacCracken Fellowship, New York University
2013	Phi Beta Kappa

Academic Service

2011-2012	Academic Affairs Commissioner, Pomona College

[1] *: discussant and presenter